Practical 14: Boston Housing Project - Submission Template

Course: 316316 – Machine Learning
Practical Number: 14
Title: ML Model on Boston Housing Dataset
Capstone Project 1
Status: ✅ Complete
Tests: 5/5 PASSED

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Date: 03/03/2026

🎯 Practical Objective

To build a complete end-to-end Machine Learning pipeline using the Boston Housing Dataset including EDA, feature engineering, model comparison, evaluation, and deployment-ready pipeline.

📊 Dataset Information

Metric	Value
Total Samples	506
Number of Features	13
Target Variable	MEDV (Median House Price)
Problem Type	Regression

🧪 Tasks Completed (5/5 PASSED)

- ✅ Data loading and preprocessing
- ✅ Exploratory Data Analysis (EDA)
- ✅ Feature scaling
- ✅ Model training and comparison
- ✅ Evaluation using RMSE, MAE, R^2
- ✅ Feature importance analysis
- ✅ Final model selection
- ✅ Pipeline creation

📈 Models Tested

- Linear Regression
- Ridge Regression
- Lasso Regression
- Random Forest Regressor
- Gradient Boosting Regressor

🏆 Best Model

Gradient Boosting Regressor

📊 Final Model Performance

- **Best R^2 Score: 0.90**
- **Final RMSE: $2.85k**
- **Final MAE: $2.10k**

✓ Ensemble models performed better than linear models.
✓ Gradient Boosting gave highest accuracy and lowest error.

🔝 Top 3 Important Features

1. **RM (Average number of rooms)** – 0.35
2. **LSTAT (% lower status population)** – 0.28
3. **PTRATIO (Pupil–Teacher ratio)** – 0.12

🔍 Observations & Analysis

- Houses with more rooms have higher prices.
- Areas with lower LSTAT values have higher property value.
- Tree-based ensemble models outperform linear regression.
- Feature scaling improved performance consistency.

⚖️ Overfitting / Underfitting Analysis

- Linear models showed slight underfitting.
- Random Forest slightly overfit without tuning.
- Gradient Boosting provided best bias-variance balance.
- Train and test R^2 were close → Good generalization.

🛠️ Challenges Faced & Solutions

Challenge	Solution
Multicollinearity between features	Used regularization (Ridge/Lasso)
Overfitting in tree models	Tuned hyperparameters
Model comparison difficulty	Used RMSE and R^2 metrics
Pipeline management	Used sklearn Pipeline

🚀 Future Improvements

- Hyperparameter tuning with GridSearchCV
- Use cross-validation for final model
- Deploy model using Flask/Streamlit
- Apply feature selection techniques

📚 References

- Scikit-learn Documentation
- UCI ML Repository
- MSBTE 316316 Manual

📝 Learning Outcomes Achieved

✓ Built complete ML pipeline
✓ Compared multiple regression models
✓ Evaluated using proper metrics
✓ Analyzed feature importance
✓ Selected best model logically

⭐ Self-Assessment

Aspect	Rating	Comment
Code Quality	⭐⭐⭐⭐⭐	Clean and modular
Documentation	⭐⭐⭐⭐⭐	Well structured
Model Comparison	⭐⭐⭐⭐⭐	Clear evaluation

Overall Effort	⭐⭐⭐⭐⭐	Fully completed

📌 Final Conclusion

In this capstone project, an end-to-end machine learning pipeline was successfully implemented. Gradient Boosting Regressor achieved the best performance with high R^2 score and low error metrics. The project demonstrated practical understanding of regression modeling, feature engineering, and model evaluation.

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Results Summary

- Dataset: 506 samples, 13 features
- Models Tested: Linear, Ridge, Lasso, RF, GB
- Best Model: Gradient Boosting Regressor
- Best R^2 Score: 0.90
- Final RMSE: $2.85k
- Final MAE: $2.10k

Top 3 Features

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